

Irrational

by Pandiculator

Two maritime figures, one real (whose final captain's surname and ship must be highlighted in the grid) and one appearing in a novel, encountered similar fates.

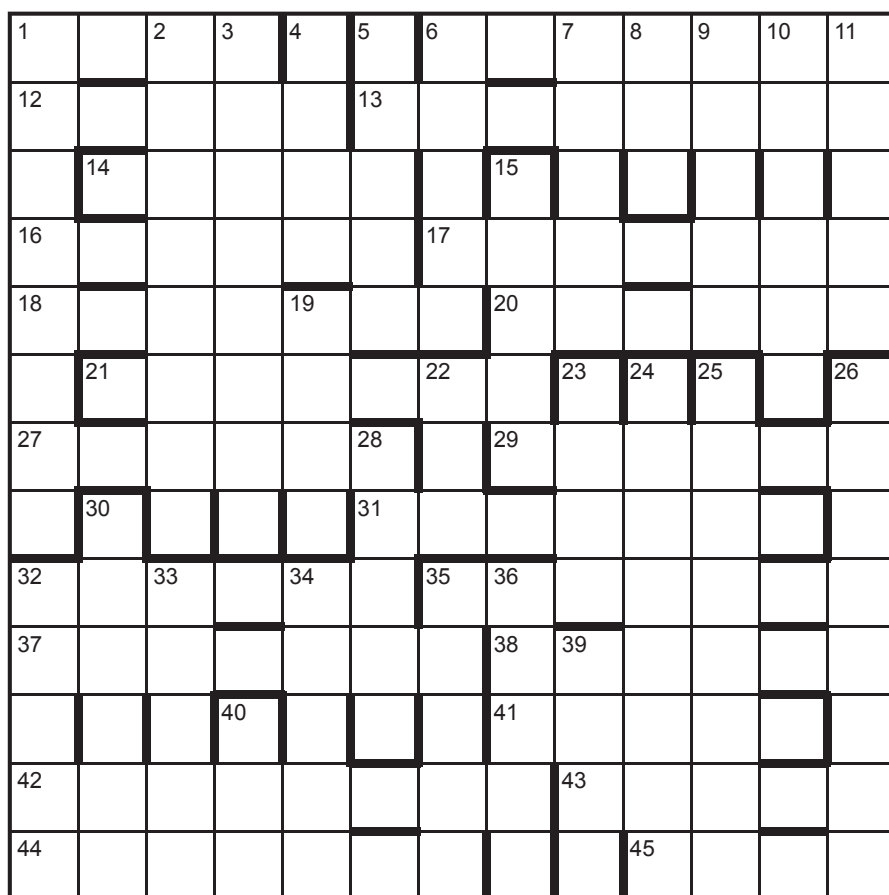
A letter must be omitted, wherever it occurs, from the answer to 13 across clues before entry in the grid.

The definition refers to the full answer while the wordplay and numbers in brackets refer to the grid entry. Omitted letters identify both figures (after resolving an ambiguity).

A word must be removed from nine down clues to enable solving.

Splitting these into phrases

of 1, 4, 2, and 2 words points towards four further words related to the novel which must be highlighted in straight lines.



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Across

- 1 Introduction lines? (4)
- 6 Unusual piece reported ill-equipped angler's problem? (7)
- 12 Tipped Greek islander to keep up (5)
- 13 Slim margin after failing to tax furniture (8, 2 words)
- 14 Biting things when around police (5)
- 16 Welsh girl's unknown in her south-eastern county (6)
- 17 Warbler's award pinched by snapper? (7)
- 18 Remarkable folk not blessed without backing of the French (7)
- 20 Card games starting late with quantities of wine (6)
- 21 Each note removed from 10 disturbing sounds strikes fear (7)
- 27 Oil company's second liner scuttled (6)
- 29 Not entirely chaste anecdotes in sacred text (6)
- 31 Add some delivered tea (7)
- 32 Letter penned by amateur astronomer learning initially of orbit's extreme (6)
- 35 Emu bit leader in showbiz wildly? Most rough (7)
- 37 Object to couple except after cross-dressing (7)
- 38 Maybe auction off aged parts of skull (6)
- 41 Supports old lepers but not the first (5)
- 42 Perhaps Morse code's ending manoeuvres due to skirmish – resume chaotic leaving (8)
- 43 Asian sheep are Ural cultivated (5)
- 44 Record of work beginning to renovate giant piston (7)
- 45 Gentleman without blood group (4)

Down

- 1 Expecting quietly prevalent author (8)
- 2 Yesterday, regularly consuming sea creature and the rest (8, 2 words)
- 3 Great opportunity, originally missed, to carry book title in Spar (8)
- 4 Motor racing taking place around many laps in Benin (4)
- 5 Extract from stage character's steamy romance that's dated (5)
- 6 US agents examine arresting Republican retrospectively (5)
- 7 Stocking ultimate in family fashion, only needing repair (5)
- 8 Reversal of these pardons on record would create meek followers (3)
- 9 German plane's mercurial tailless beauty (5)
- 10 Shaft railway like formidable competitor (6)
- 11 Idle and then some? English surveyors (5)
- 15 Get prince admitted by doctor (5)
- 19 Temperature underlying bad cycling cadence (4)
- 22 Italian dictator losing head over bit of French (3)
- 23 US flower merchant's left to act quietly (4)
- 24 Short films tsar's covering broadcast serial (8)
- 25 Team primarily entertained by pale ale name deforming caps (8)
- 26 Coastal defence's onboard medieval weapon beginning to look old (8)
- 28 Animal left in my Hebridean island (5)
- 30 Started without issue and spoke (6)
- 32 Switches in chip shop finally disposed of by furnisher (5)
- 33 Stricken dullard's very good about address (5)
- 34 Local to tolerate Shakespearean pursuer? (5)
- 35 Vessel from the south secure under black shrub (5)
- 36 Run out, pursue wildly, tire out (5, 2 words)
- 39 Twin's contribution to apple sauce (4)
- 40 Side of field's smooth – not half! (3)